

Indiana Esports Network

Valorant

Competition Ruleset

2026-2027

Competition Status:

Varsity / JV

Competition Format:

Team-Based

Platform:

PC

Ruleset Version:

1.0

Effective Date:

8/3/26



Document Information

Information

Details

Game Title

Valorant

Publisher

Riot Games

Season

Season 2026 (V26)

Competition Level

Varsity / JV

Version

1.0

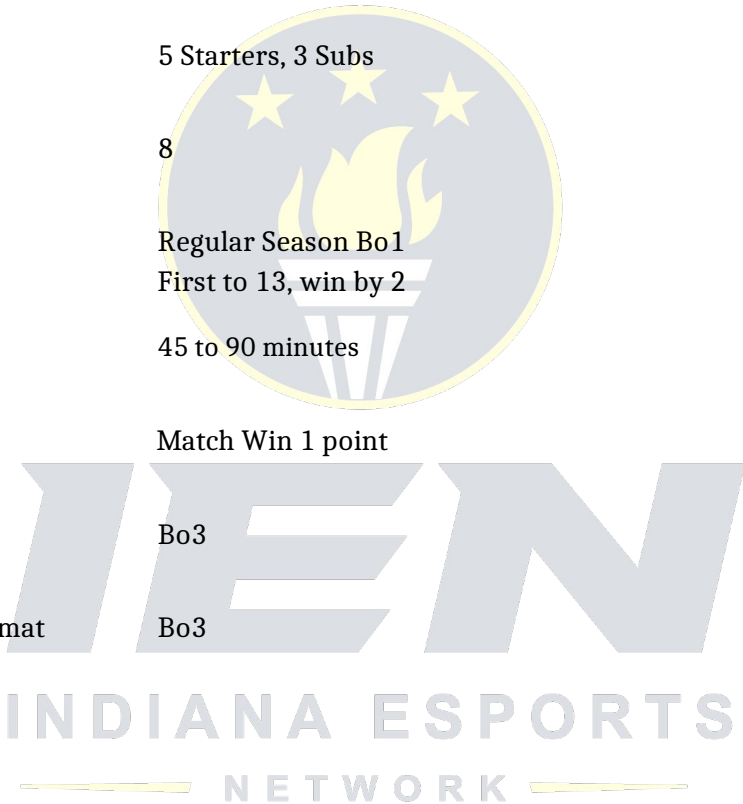
Effective Date

6/24/26

Quick Reference

This section provides a summary of the most important competition information.

Category	Information
Competition Type	Team
Platform	PC
Team Size	5 Starters, 3 Subs
Maximum Roster	8
Match Format	Regular Season Bo1 First to 13, win by 2
Match Length	45 to 90 minutes
Scoring System	Match Win 1 point
Playoff Format	Bo3
Championship Format	Bo3

The logo for Indiana Esports Network (IEN) is centered in the background of the table. It features a circular emblem with a torch and three stars, with the letters 'IEN' in a large, stylized font below it, and 'INDIANA ESPORTS NETWORK' in a smaller font at the bottom.

Coach Checklist

Before the Season

- ☐ Register team/player information with IEN
 - ☐ Verify student eligibility
 - ☐ Review competition rules
 - ☐ Confirm required equipment
 - ☐ Ensure players have approved accounts
 - ☐ Review schedule and deadlines
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Before Each Match

- ☐ Confirm roster availability
 - ☐ Update game software
 - ☐ Verify settings
 - ☐ Confirm opponent communication
 - ☐ Prepare required equipment
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1. Competition Overview

1.1 Purpose

The Indiana Esports Network (IEN) establishes this ruleset to define the official competition standards for **Valorant**.

This document provides the information required for schools, coaches, and students to participate in IEN competition.

All participants must also follow the requirements established in the current IEN Member Handbook.

1.2 Competition Model

Competition Type:

Team-Based

Description:

Valorant is a team-based tactical first-person shooter in which two schools compete using teams of five players. Teams alternate between attacking and defending objectives across a series of rounds. The attacking team seeks to plant and detonate the Spike, while the defending team attempts to prevent the plant or successfully defuse the Spike. Teams earn rounds through objective completion or by eliminating all opposing players. Success requires precise communication, teamwork, strategic agent selection, map control, and coordinated execution of tactics throughout the match.

2. Team and Player Structure

2.1 Roster Information

Requirement	Details
Minimum Roster	5 starters 1sub
Maximum Roster	8
Active Players	5
Substitutes	3

2.2 Coaches

Coach requirements:

All coach eligibility, supervision, and participation requirements are governed by the IEN Bylaws and General Competition Rules.

3. Match Format

3.1 Competition Format

Valorant competitions shall be conducted in a **5-versus-5 team format**, with each school fielding five eligible players for each match.

- Matches shall be played using the current competitive ruleset and map pool approved by Riot Games and adopted by IEN.
- Teams alternate between the **Attacker** and **Defender** roles during the match.
- The Attacking team attempts to plant and detonate the **Spike**, while the Defending team attempts to prevent the plant or successfully defuse the Spike.
- A round may also be won by eliminating all opposing players.
- The first team to win **13 rounds** is declared the winner of the map.
- Teams switch sides after the first **12 rounds** of play.

Overtime

If the score is tied **12-12** at the end of regulation:

- Overtime procedures shall be conducted in accordance with the current Riot Games competitive ruleset and IEN competition policies.
- Play shall continue until a winner is determined.

Match Winner

- The team that wins the required number of maps for the match format shall be declared the match winner.
- Regular season matches shall be played as **Best-of-One (Bo1)** unless otherwise specified by IEN.
- Postseason matches may be played as **Best-of-Three (Bo3)** or another format determined by IEN.

3.2 Match Structure

Category	Details
Match Type	Regular Season Bo1 Post-Season Bo3
Games Per Match	1
Victory Condition	A team wins a Valorant map by being the first team to secure 13 rounds and wins by 2

3.3 Tie Procedures

If a tie occurs:

If a map is tied **12-12** at the end of regulation play, overtime shall be played in accordance with the current Riot Games competitive ruleset.

- Teams shall continue playing overtime rounds until a winner is determined.
- Overtime shall consist of alternating attacking and defending rounds as specified by the game.
- The first team to achieve the required overtime victory condition shall be declared the winner of the map.

Match Ties

Valorant matches cannot end in a tie. If a winner cannot be determined due to technical issues, server failure, or extraordinary circumstances, League Administration may:

- Restart the map.
- Resume play from an approved game state when supported by tournament tools.
- Award a forfeit if applicable.
- Issue any other ruling deemed necessary to preserve competitive integrity.

4. Competition Schedule

4.1 Regular Season

Season dates:

Preseason 10/15/26-10/29/26

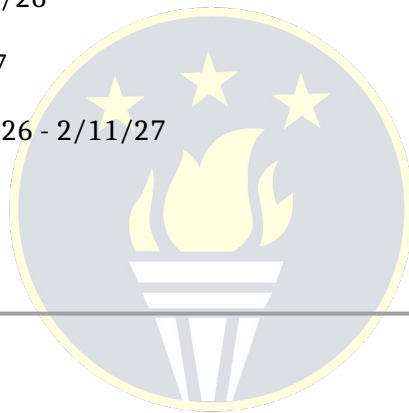
Regular Season 11/5/26-12/10/26

Winter Break 12/11/26-1/3/27

Regular Season (continue) 1/7/26 - 2/11/27

Playoffs 2/25/27 - 3/18/27

Finals 4/24/27



5. Official Game Settings

5.1 Required Settings

IEN competitions will use:

- Lobby: Custom (closed)
- Mode: Standard
- Allow Cheats: Off
- Tournament Mode: On
- Overtime Win by Two: On
- Individually Player settings (set on each players' own computer):
 - Shows corpses: On
 - Show blood: Off

5.2 Approved Maps / Arenas / Courses / Stages

Maps | Any map included in the current Valorant Competitive Play map pool as published by Riot Games.

5.3 Restricted Content

The following are not permitted:

- Any heroes currently disabled in the ranked queue will be unavailable for IEN matches. Any newly released heroes will be unavailable for IEN matches for a period of 2 weeks after official release.
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6. Document History

Version	Date	Changes
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1.0	8/3/26	Initial Release
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